



USA 250

Dot-to-Dot Activity Book

Celebrate America's 250th Birthday!

4 Fun Dot-to-Dot Puzzles · 48 to 94 Dots · Ages 4-10



Connect the dots · Learn American history · Colour your creations!

? Gas Balloon · Eagle Kite · Fireworks · Party Balloons ?

July 4, 1776 ? July 4, 2026 · 250 Years of Freedom!



USA 250 Dot-to-Dot Activity Book
Celebrate America's 250th Birthday!

First Edition ? 2026

All puzzle designs and text in this book are original creations.

This book is dedicated to every child who has ever connected a dot, followed a number, and revealed something wonderful on the other side.

?? ? ?? ? ?? ? ??

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Each puzzle in this book comes with:

- ? An introduction that sets the scene
- ? The dot-to-dot puzzle itself
- ? Fun facts and guided sections to help you learn

Start at dot 1. Draw a line to dot 2. Continue in order until you reach the last dot. Then ? the magic! ? a picture appears. Use coloured pencils, markers, or crayons to bring it to life.

?? ? ?? ? ?? ? ??

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

Dot-to-dot puzzles build number recognition, pencil control, hand-eye coordination, and sequential thinking. The themed content in this book connects each activity to American history, making every puzzle a mini lesson in the story of the United States.

Puzzles are graded by dot count:

- ? 48 dots ? Beginner (Ages 4?7)
- ? 80 dots ? Easy (Ages 5?9)
- ? 90 dots ? Easy-Medium (Ages 6?10)
- ? 94 dots ? Easy-Medium (Ages 6?10)

On July 4, 2026, the United States of America celebrates its 250th birthday ? a milestone known as the Semiquincentennial.

It all began on July 4, 1776, when the Continental Congress adopted the Declaration of Independence, proclaiming to the world that thirteen American colonies were now free and independent states. That bold act changed history forever.

? KEY MOMENTS IN 250 YEARS ?

1776 The Declaration of Independence is signed in Philadelphia.

1787 The U.S. Constitution is written ? still the world's longest-surviving written national constitution.

1793 The first gas balloon flight in America launches from Philadelphia, watched by President George Washington.

1800 The capital moves to Washington, D.C., the city built specifically to be the seat of American government.

1865 The Civil War ends. The 13th Amendment abolishes slavery, fulfilling the promise of freedom for all Americans.

1903 The Wright Brothers make the first powered aeroplane flight at Kitty Hawk, North Carolina.

1969 Astronaut Neil Armstrong becomes the first human to walk on the Moon, planting an American flag on the lunar surface.

1976 The United States celebrates its Bicentennial ? 200 years of independence ? with fireworks and festivities nationwide.

2026 America's 250th birthday! The Semiquincentennial is celebrated with parades, fireworks, art, music, and activities like this book.

From those first 13 colonies to 50 states spanning a continent, America's story is one of courage, discovery, and the enduring belief that all people are created equal. Happy 250th birthday, USA! ?

Celebrate 250 Years of America!

America is turning 250 years old ? a quarter millennium of history, invention, and adventure! What better way to celebrate than soaring above the festivities in a magnificent gas balloon? Gas balloons were one of the very first flying machines, and Americans have loved them since the earliest days of the republic. Grab a pencil, find dot 1, and let's send this balloon up into the celebration sky!

DRAWING GUIDE · WHAT YOU ARE DRAWING AND WHY

Dots 1-10 · The Balloon Envelope

The large, rounded top of the balloon envelope holds the gas that makes it fly. Gas balloons are filled with lighter-than-air gas ? often helium today. The round shape spreads pressure evenly in all directions.

Dots 11-22 · The Stars and Stripes Detail

The Flag Act of 1818 set the modern rule of 13 stripes, with one star for each state. Early balloonists sometimes decorated their envelopes with patriotic colours and symbols.

Dots 23-34 · The Netting and Load Ring

The rope netting around gas balloons helps spread the weight of the basket across the envelope. Sharing the weight over many ropes helps the balloon stay balanced and strong.

Dots 35-42 · The Suspension Ropes and Basket

Balloon baskets ? called gondolas ? have been made from wicker for over 200 years. Wicker is lightweight and flexible, bending gently during landing. Sometimes the old ways really are the best ways!

Dots 43-48 · The Flag and Finishing Touches

America's first balloon pilot was Jean-Pierre Blanchard, who flew from Philadelphia on 9 January 1793. President George Washington gave him a letter of safe passage ? which proved very useful when he landed in a New Jersey farm field!

· DID YOU KNOW?

The first gas balloon flight in America took place in 1793 ? George Washington himself watched it launch in Philadelphia!



Start at dot 1 ? connect in order ? reveal the picture ? colour it in!



Wonderful work ? your USA 250 gas balloon is ready to soar! That's 48 dots and one sky full of celebration. Colour it in red, white, and blue to mark America's amazing 250th birthday. Happy anniversary, USA!

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Soar with the American Eagle for USA's 250th!

America is celebrating its 250th birthday, and the nation's most iconic symbol – the bald eagle – is here to lead the festivities! With a patriotic banner streaming behind it, this majestic bird soars high over the celebration. Eagles have stood for American freedom and strength since the very earliest days of the republic. Grab your pencil, find dot 1, and let's send this eagle soaring!

DRAWING GUIDE · WHAT YOU ARE DRAWING AND WHY

Dots 1-16 · The Eagle's Head and Beak

Bald eagles are not actually bald – their name comes from an old English word 'balde,' meaning white. The striking white head feathers appear when the bird reaches adulthood at around five years old.

Dots 17-36 · The Outstretched Wings

A bald eagle's wingspan can reach up to 2.4 metres – almost eight feet tip to tip – making it one of the largest birds of prey in North America. Eagles can soar on thermal currents for hours without a single wingbeat.

Dots 37-54 · The Tail Feathers and Talons

An eagle's talons can grip with a force of around 400 pounds per square inch – many times stronger than a human hand. Special spiky soles (spicules) help grip slippery fish pulled straight from rivers and lakes.

Dots 55-68 · The Patriotic Banner

On the Great Seal of the United States, the eagle holds a ribbon reading 'E Pluribus Unum' – Latin for 'Out of Many, One' – a motto that has appeared on American coins and documents since 1782.

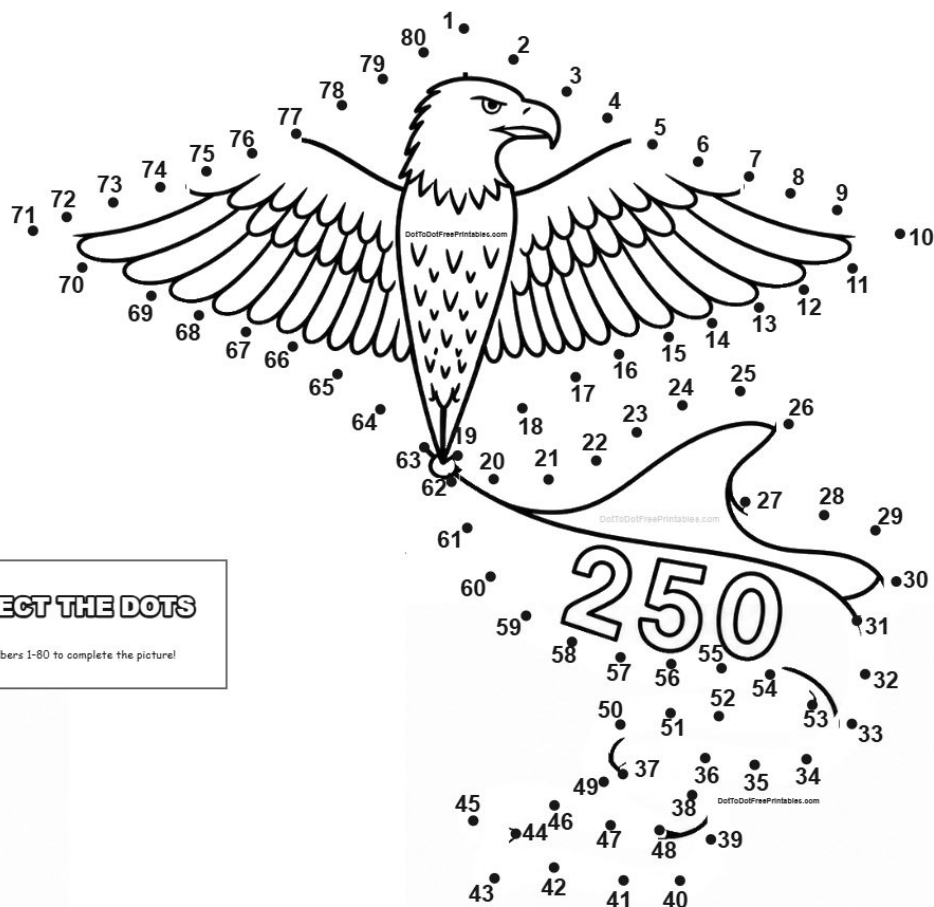
Dots 69-80 · The Stars and Finishing Touches

The 50 stars on the American flag each represent one of the 50 states. The most recent change came in 1960, when Hawaii's star was added. The current 50-star design has been the official flag for longer than any other version in American history.

· DID YOU KNOW?

The bald eagle was adopted as part of the Great Seal of the United States in 1782 – just six years after the Declaration of Independence was signed!

Start at dot 1 ? connect in order ? reveal the picture ? colour it in!



CONNECT THE DOTS

Join the numbers 1-80 to complete the picture!

Magnificent work ? your USA 250 eagle is soaring with pride! That's 80 dots and one spectacular symbol of American freedom. Colour the eagle in brown and white, the banner in red and gold, and the stars in red, white, and blue. Happy anniversary, USA!

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· DID YOU KNOW?

Light Up the Sky for America's 250th Birthday!

America is turning 250 years old ? and what better way to mark a quarter millennium than with a sky full of dazzling fireworks? Fireworks have lit up the Fourth of July since the very earliest days of the nation, turning the night sky into a canvas of colour and light. Grab your pencil, find dot 1, and let's set off this spectacular birthday display!

DRAWING GUIDE · WHAT YOU ARE DRAWING AND WHY

Dots 1-18 · The Night Sky

On a clear night away from city lights, you can see up to 4,500 stars with the naked eye. That same sky greeted the Founding Fathers when they first celebrated independence in 1776.

Dots 19-36 · The First Firework Burst

Fireworks were invented in China over 1,000 years ago. The recipe eventually reached Europe and then the Americas, where it became the signature sound and light of celebration.

Dots 37-54 · The Cascading Sparks

Different colours in fireworks come from burning different metal salts: strontium = red, barium = green, copper = blue, sodium = yellow. Mixing salts lets pyrotechnicians paint the sky with almost any colour they choose.

Dots 55-72 · The Grand Finale Burst

The 'grand finale' tradition came about because early pyrotechnicians wanted to end shows with maximum impact. Today's grand finales can fire hundreds of shells per minute, turning the sky almost as bright as daylight for a thrilling few seconds.

Dots 73-90 · Stars, Flag and Finishing Touches

The American flag has 50 stars and 13 stripes representing the original colonies. On the Fourth of July it is flown from sunrise to sunset at homes, schools, and government buildings across the entire country.

· DID YOU KNOW?

Fireworks have been part of American Independence Day celebrations since the very first anniversary on 4 July 1777 ? just one year after the Declaration of Independence was signed!

Start at dot 1 ? connect in order ? reveal the picture ? colour it in!



Brilliant work ? your America 250 fireworks display is lighting up the sky! That's 90 dots and one spectacular birthday celebration. Colour the bursts in red, white, and blue to give America the most patriotic send-off possible. Happy 250th birthday, USA!

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· DID YOU KNOW?

America is turning 250 years old, and this puzzle is ready for the party! Balloons, stars, and bright patriotic details come together in a cheerful birthday scene for the USA. Grab a pencil, find dot 1, and start connecting your way through the celebration.

Modern party balloons are often made from latex, a stretchy natural material. When filled with air or helium, the balloon expands evenly in every direction, creating its familiar rounded shape.

Large balloon displays are popular at parades and community events because they are lightweight, colourful, and easy to arrange into arches, columns, and festive backdrops.

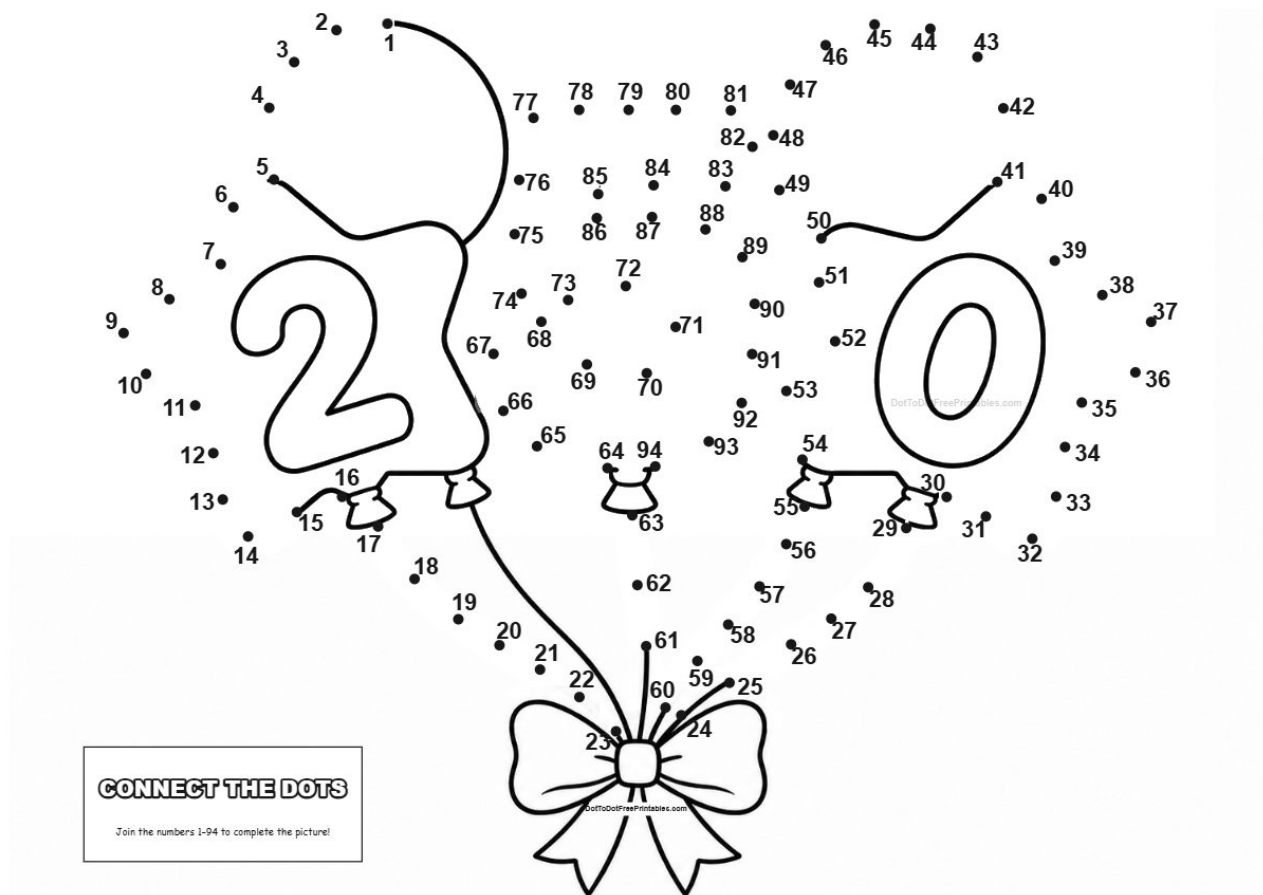
Stars are one of the most familiar American symbols because each star on the United States flag represents one state in the union. The first flag had just 13 stars for 13 colonies.

The United States celebrates Independence Day on July 4 because the Declaration of Independence was adopted on July 4, 1776 ? 250 years before the celebrations of 2026.

America's 250th birthday ? the Semiquincentennial ? is celebrated on July 4, 2026, marking 250 years since the bold signing of the Declaration of Independence.

Balloons became popular party decorations in the 1800s. Today red, white, and blue balloons are a cheerful way to decorate parades and community celebrations for America's birthday!

Start at dot 1 ? connect in order ? reveal the picture ? colour it in!



Fantastic work ? your USA 250 birthday balloons are ready for the party! Colour the balloons and stars in red, white, and blue to finish a bright patriotic celebration for America's 250th birthday.

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WHAT DID YOU LEARN? · SECTION FACTS RECAP

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Modern party balloons are often made from latex, a stretchy natural material. When filled with air or helium, the balloon expands evenly in every direction, creating its familiar rounded shape.

· Dots 19-38 · The Celebration Cluster

Large balloon displays are popular at parades and community events because they are lightweight, colourful, and easy to arrange into arches, columns, and festive backdrops.

· Dots 39-58 · The Stars

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· Dots 59-76 · The Birthday Details

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· Dots 77-94 · The Final Party Lines

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• **DID YOU KNOW?**

Now that you've completed your dot-to-dot puzzles, it's time to bring them to life with colour! Here are some tips to make your pictures look fantastic.

?? ? PATRIOTIC COLOUR PALETTE ? ??

For all your USA 250 puzzles, the classic colours are:

- ? RED ? for balloons, firework bursts, and flag stripes
- ? BLUE ? for the sky, flag canton, and banner backgrounds
- ? WHITE ? for the eagle's head, stars on the flag, and highlights
- ? GOLD ? for banner borders, eagle talons, and star accents
- ? BROWN ? for the eagle's body feathers and wicker baskets

?? ? COLOURING TECHNIQUES ? ??

PENCIL CONTROL

Colour in small, circular motions rather than back-and-forth strokes. This gives a smoother, more even colour with no white streaks.

LAYERING

Apply a light layer first, then add more pressure for darker areas. Layering two colours ? for example, red over orange ? creates beautiful depth.

SHADING

Colour the edges of a shape darker than the middle to make it look rounded and three-dimensional. Try this on the balloon envelope!

LEAVING HIGHLIGHTS

Leave a small white area near the top of round shapes (like balloons) uncoloured. This looks like light reflecting off a shiny surface.

?? ? CHOOSING YOUR TOOLS ? ??

- Coloured pencils ? Best for fine details and gentle shading.
Felt-tip markers ? Great for bold, bright fills on larger areas.
Watercolour paints ? Beautiful for skies and backgrounds; let dry fully.
Crayons ? Fun and easy for younger artists.

?? ? TOP TIP ? ??

Always test your colours on a spare piece of paper first to make sure they look the way you want before colouring your finished puzzle. Take your time ? the slower and more carefully you colour, the better the result will be. Every masterpiece is worth the patience!

Learn these fun facts to impress your friends and family while you celebrate America's 250th birthday!

?? THE UNITED STATES IN NUMBERS

50 ? the number of states in the Union

13 ? the number of original colonies that became states

250 ? years America celebrates in 2026

4 ? the date in July when America celebrates Independence Day

1776 ? the year the Declaration of Independence was signed

538 ? the number of electoral votes in a U.S. presidential election

? THE BALD EAGLE

The bald eagle became the national bird of the United States in 1782. It was chosen because it represents freedom, strength, and long life. By the 1960s, bald eagles were nearly extinct due to hunting and pesticides. Thanks to conservation efforts, over 300,000 bald eagles soar across North America today!

? FOURTH OF JULY FIREWORKS

Americans spend over one billion dollars on fireworks every year for the Fourth of July! The largest fireworks display in the United States is held in New York City over the East River each year.

? GAS BALLOONS IN AMERICA

The first person to cross the English Channel in a gas balloon was Jean-Pierre Blanchard ? the same man who made the first balloon flight in America in 1793. Today, the Albuquerque International Balloon Fiesta in New Mexico is the largest hot-air balloon festival in the world, drawing nearly 100,000 visitors.

? THE AMERICAN FLAG

The current 50-star flag was designed by Robert G. Heft in 1958, when he was just 17 years old ? as a school project! His teacher initially gave him a B-minus for the design. When President Eisenhower chose it as the official flag in 1960, Heft's teacher changed the grade to an A!

? THE DECLARATION OF INDEPENDENCE

The Declaration of Independence has 1,320 words and was signed by 56 delegates. The original document is kept at the National Archives in Washington, D.C., where millions of people visit it every year.

★ USA 250 Word Scramble! ★

Unscramble each word below ? they are all connected to America's 250th birthday!

1. **NDECENDEEPIN**

(Declaration of ____)

Answer: _____

2. **MRECAIA**

(name of the country)

Answer: _____

3. **DELIPALHAPHI**

(city where it began)

Answer: _____

4. **ERDIGEFISW**

(fireworks go off with a ____)

Answer: _____

5. **ELLDBA GEALE**

(national bird)

Answer: _____

6. **SYRTIFEODMN**

(the 4th of July is _ Day)

Answer: _____

7. **LLNOBOA**

(floats in the air)

Answer: _____

8. **RLGSEATNSP**

(stars and ____ on the flag)

Answer: _____

9. **TOTCDIO**

(connect the ____)

Answer: _____

10. **MSENIQNIUTLECNA**

(250th anniversary word)

Answer: _____

ANSWERS (read upside-down!):

INDEPENDENCE · AMERICA · PHILADELPHIA · FIREWORKS · BALD EAGLE · FREEDOM · BALLOON · STARSTRIPES ? STRIPES ·
DOT-TO-DOT · SEMIQUINCENTENNIAL

★ ★ ★ ★ ★ USA 250 Quiz · Test Your Knowledge! ★ ★ ★ ★ ★

Circle the correct answer for each question. Answers are at the bottom of the page!

Q1. In what year was the Declaration of Independence signed?

- A) 1620
- B) 1776
- C) 1812
- D) 1865

Q2. What is the national bird of the United States?

- A) Turkey
- B) Robin
- C) Bald Eagle
- D) Blue Jay

Q3. How many stars are on the current American flag?

- A) 13
- B) 48
- C) 50
- D) 52

Q4. What is America's 250th birthday celebration called?

- A) Bicentennial
- B) Tricentennial
- C) Sesquicentennial
- D) Semiquincentennial

Q5. Who watched the first gas balloon flight in America in 1793?

- A) Abraham Lincoln
- B) George Washington
- C) Thomas Jefferson
- D) Benjamin Franklin

Q6. How many original colonies became the first states?

- A) 13
- B) 15
- C) 26
- D) 50

Q7. What date is Independence Day celebrated in the United States?

- A) June 14
- B) July 1
- C) July 4
- D) August 15

Q8. What does 'E Pluribus Unum' mean?

- A) Land of the Free
- B) Out of Many, One
- C) In God We Trust
- D) We the People

ANSWERS:

Q1: B · Q2: C · Q3: C · Q4: D · Q5: B · Q6: A · Q7: C · Q8: B
Score: 8/8 = Patriot Expert! · 6-7 = Star-Spangled Scholar · 4-5 = History Explorer



? CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT ?

USA 250 Dot-to-Dot Activity Book

This certifies that

(write your name here)

has successfully completed all four USA 250 Dot-to-Dot puzzles
and celebrated America's 250th birthday with creativity, patience,
and patriotic spirit!



July 4, 1776 ? July 4, 2026

250 Years of Freedom, Courage, and Discovery!

Parent / Teacher

Date



Happy Birthday, USA! ????



WHY DOT-TO-DOT?

Dot-to-dot puzzles have been a favourite children's activity for over a century. They were first published in newspapers and magazines in the early 1900s, delighting children and adults alike with the magic of a hidden picture that only reveals itself when every dot is connected.

?? ? SKILLS YOU PRACTISE ? ??

NUMBER RECOGNITION

Following dots in the right order means reading and recognising numbers quickly. This skill is foundational for mathematics and logical thinking.

PENCIL CONTROL

Drawing a line from dot to dot with precision builds the fine motor skills children need for handwriting, drawing, and many everyday tasks.

SEQUENTIAL THINKING

Every dot-to-dot puzzle teaches children that order matters ? that following a sequence step-by-step leads to a satisfying result. This is a fundamental problem-solving skill used in coding, cooking, music, and more.

PATIENCE AND FOCUS

Larger puzzles (like the 94-dot Birthday Balloons!) require sustained concentration. Completing a long puzzle builds the 'sticking with it' habit that helps in school and in life.

CREATIVITY

Once the puzzle is done, colouring it in is a free creative exercise. There are no rules about which colours to choose ? the finished picture belongs entirely to the artist!

?? ? TIPS FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS ? ??

- ? Work through the first puzzle together with your child to build confidence.
- ? Let children choose their own colour palette ? even purple eagles are wonderful!
- ? Read the 'Did You Know?' facts aloud for a mini history lesson.
- ? Display finished colouring pages as art ? a pride boost that encourages more!
- ? Use the quiz and word scramble for classroom group activities.

?? ? ?? ? ?? ? ??

Thank you for celebrating America's 250th birthday with us! We hope these puzzles brought joy, learning, and a little patriotic pride to your home or classroom. Happy 250th birthday, USA! ?

